

Vocations In today's gospel Jesus teaches a powerful lesson on forgiveness. We pray for the men called to priesthood that, as they celebrate the Sacrament of Reconciliation with their people, they will help them to know and experience the Lord who '*...is compassion and love, slow to anger, and rich in mercy.*' (Responsorial Psalm).

Parish Draw Promoters should make their returns for September to the Parish Office on **Monday 21 September from 2.00pm - 4.30pm**. The Draw for September will take place on Thursday 24 September at 10.30am in the Parish Office.

Baptism Dates Melmount

September: Saturday 19.

October: Sunday 4; Saturday 10; Saturday 17; Saturday 24.

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14; Saturday 21; Saturday 28.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

The Columban Young Adults are a new group for those aged 18 – 30 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our September event will be a Holy Hour and meditation on Thursday 17 September, 7.00pm at Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by Fr. Declan McGeehan. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments. We are actively seeking new members. Please come along and bring a friend!

Coffee Morning in aid of Foyle Hospice will be held in Murphy's on the Green on Friday 25 September from 9.30am – 12.30pm. Draw tickets £1.00 per line will be available on the day, the Draw will be held at 1.00pm.

Could You Help Share the True Spirit of Christmas? Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell **Trócaire Gifts of Change** – meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. We provide

everything you need including training and support. All we ask is a little time and a big heart. Last Christmas 50 parishes took part – and we'd love to grow that number even more this year! If you would like to find out more about how you can help, please email Mark at **Mark.Mcmahon@Trocaire.Org** or call 028 90808030.

Rise and Shine Trust Easter 2027 Pilgrimage Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11 – 30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with the Rise and Shine Trust. *The trip is free to guests travelling with the Group.* The application form is available online at riseandshine.ie. Closing date for applications is 15 October 2026. Applications are also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests on the trip. Carers applications at riseandshine.ie. For more information visit **Www.Riseandshine.Ie** or contact Sian 07960211352 or Maurice 07711504821.

Michael English Church Concert An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15 pm in St. Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30.00 and available to buy at Heron's Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Deresrtmartin Parish Office or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>.

Sion Mills Buildings Preservation Trust Heritage Open Day at The Stables, Sion Mills Sunday 13 September Museum open 2.00pm – 5.00pm. Heritage Trial at 2.00pm.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@

Dlp@Derrydiocese.Org

Social Work Services 0800 1979 995.